08-08 第二篇

Learning to Apologize: A Skill for Life

Everyone makes mistakes. What matters is how we respond when we hurt someone, whether by accident or on purpose. A sincere apology can repair damaged relationships and restore trust. However, many people find it difficult to say "I'm sorry" in a meaningful way. [1] Understanding why apologies matter and how to deliver them well is a skill that benefits us throughout our lives. It starts with recognizing the impact of our actions on others.

The first step in apologizing well is to take responsibility. [2] Avoid phrases like "I'm sorry if you were offended" or "It was just a joke." Such words shift the focus away from your actions and make the hurt person feel dismissed. Instead, clearly state what you did wrong and show that you understand how it affected them. A real apology accepts full ownership of the mistake.

Timing and sincerity also matter a great deal. [3] Apologizing too quickly can seem rushed; waiting too long can make the other person feel that you do not care. The best time is when you have calmed down and can speak from the heart. Look the person in the eye, use a steady voice, and avoid making excuses. Your body language and tone should match your words.

After apologizing, give the other person space. [4] They may need time to process their feelings and decide whether to forgive. Pushing for instant forgiveness or getting defensive if they are not ready only makes things worse. Patience shows that you respect their emotions and are serious about making things right. Sometimes, rebuilding trust takes weeks or months.

[5] Apologizing is not a sign of weakness but of strength. It takes courage to admit fault and face someone we have hurt. When we learn to apologize well, we become better friends, family members, and colleagues. We also teach others, by example, that mistakes can be acknowledged and relationships can heal.

选项

A. This knowledge helps us repair harm and build stronger connections. B. Owning our mistakes directly makes an apology believable. C. How and when we say sorry affects whether it is accepted. D. Respecting the other person's pace strengthens the chance of healing. E. Mastering this skill reflects our character and improves our relationships. F. For example, a study found that people who apologize well are perceived as more trustworthy.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前指出真诚道歉能修复关系、恢复信任，但很多人难以好好道歉；空后强调理解其重要性与方法。A项"这种认识帮助我们弥补伤害并建立更牢固的联系"承上（为何道歉重要）启下（如何学好道歉），衔接自然。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：本段主题为承担责任，批评"if you were offended"式推责，强调明确承认错误、理解影响。B项"直接承担我们的错误使道歉可信"与avoid shifting focus、accept full ownership逻辑一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：段中讨论时机（太快/太晚）及真诚（眼神、语气、不找借口）。C项"我们如何以及何时道歉会影响是否被接受"概括本段关于时机与表达方式的内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：段首说give space，后文写需要时间消化、不要强迫原谅、耐心表示尊重。D项"尊重对方的节奏会增加和解的机会"与段意相符。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段以[5]开头，后文强调道歉是勇气与力量的体现，能成为更好的朋友、家人、同事，并以身作则。E项"掌握这项技能反映我们的品格并改善我们的关系"总领全段。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example...**：以For example开头，虽与道歉、信任相关，但仅为研究结论的单一引用，与任一段落的概括或承启功能不符，论述层次错位。